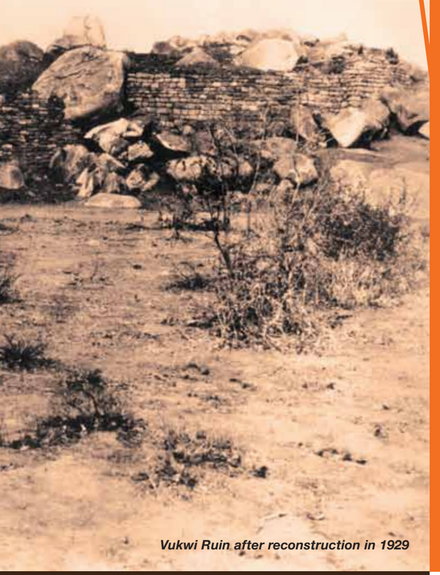
THE GREATER FRANCISTOWN HERITAGE TRAIL



Vukwi Ruin after reconstruction in 1929

Introduction

1. BACKGROUND INFORMATION
This heritage trail serves as a guide promoting cultural heritage tourism in the Greater Francistown region. It covers over 30 sites which showcase the natural and cultural heritage of the Bukalanga area. Archaeological and historical sites, rock paintings, shrines, stone walled ruins and contemporary cultural centres found here form the diverse heritage of the Bukalanga region.

2. HISTORY of the AREA
The Bakalanga people are made up of three distinct groups. The 'original' Bakalanga known as Balilima include the Bawumbe from Madandume in Tutume, Nshakazhogwe, Mosojane, Mulambakwena, Zwenshambe, Dabgwi, Tsamaya and Senete. Balilima venerate Tjibelu. The second group consists of the Banyayi who venerate Moyo. These include the Batalaunda, Bamengwe, BaChangate and the Banandzwa. The last group is made up of Sotho Tswana people who moved into Bukalanga region during the 18th century. They adopted Ikalanga as their language. These include Bapedi of Tjilagwane, Nswazwi, Masunga and Ngwadi, Bakhurutshe of Matobo, Bakaa and Barolong of Sebina and the Barolong of Moroka.

3. HOW to GET THERE
The starting point of this trail is Francistown City. The majority of sites are accessible by a 4x2 van. Access roads, signage, camp sites and custodians are available at some of these sites. Apart from the sites in the Francistown Trail, it is essential to visit the kgotla to get permission. "Dumilani bazwadzwi" with a smile is the acceptable greeting among Bakalanga.

LIST of ALL SITES

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1. Shashe Dam
2. Shashe Money Tree
3. Tachila Nature Reserve
4. Supa Ngwao Museum
5. Hexagonal Building
6. St Patrick's Church
7. Monarch Mine
8. Ntshe Dolley Holes
9. Nyangabwe Hill
10. Gerald Estate Monument
11. Historic Cemetery
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14. Railway Station

DATI TRAIL
15. Tshesebe Fig Tree
16. Moroka Zezuru Potters
17. Tati Training Institute
18. Gandanyemba Hills
19. Machokochoko Hills
20. Thanga ya ka Mosojane

DOMBOSHABA TRAIL
21. Domboshaba Ruins
22. Vukwi Ruins
23. Kalakamati Rock Paintings
24. Mantenge Wells and Paintings
25. Ntimbale Landscape

NSWAZWI TRAIL
26. Schermer's Ruins
27. BB1 Kgotla
28. Nswazwi Royal Cemetery
29. Old Nswazwi Church
30. Nswazwi Potters
31. Magapatona Ruins

botswana tourism

DATI TRAIL

15 Tshesebe Fig Tree



This magnificent Ntulukusi tree is the most outstanding and scenic natural feature in Tshesebe.

It is at least 100 years old and has a wide spread measuring over 40 metres.

16 Moroka Zezuru Potters



This fascinating craft centre is operated by Zezuru women. These potters specialise in production and selling of big hand - made beer pots.

The pots are made using a coil technique. They are hardened by boiling with a special resin.

17 Tati Training Institute



The first post-primary school in Botswana was built in 1932 by Kgalemang Tumediso Motsete. Its ruins are located about 5 km west of Mosojane village at Nyewele. It closed in 1941 having produced about 322 graduates.

18 Gandanyemba Hills



Gandanyemba Hills are located 2 km north of Nlapkhwane. Rock paintings of people in trance dances and some geometric figures are found here.

A refuge settlement that was occupied by Bakalanga people during King Mzilikazi's rule can be seen here.



19 Machokochoko Hills

This is located about 5 km west of Gandanyemba Hills.

Rock paintings of giraffes, antelopes and human figures holding hands are found here. There are also refuge sites occupied by Bakalanga during the raids of Mzilikazi's Ndebele.

20 Thanga ya ka Mosojane

Various Bakalanga people congregate in this shrine after harvesting their crops.

They dance Ndazula, Woso, Iperu and Maile and offer thanksgiving to Mwali. Hosana from different Bakalanga villages dance here to ask for rain from Mwali.

DOMBOSHABA TRAIL

21 Domboshaba Ruins



Domboshaba Ruins was built during the Great Zimbabwe period around 1400 AD. It functioned as an important regional centre during the Bakalanga state known as Butua.

A regional chief lived on the hill complex while his wives and sisters lived on the lower enclosure. The first reported excavations in Botswana were undertaken here in 1929 by a German group known as the Frobenius Expedition. Chinese celadon porcelain, glass beads and clay birds were found here.

22 Vukwi Ruins



Vukwi is a small platform ruin located 3 km north of Sechele village. It served as the residence of a chief during the state of Butua. The site was excavated in 1929 by the Frobenius Expedition.
Clay birds similar to soapstone birds found at Great Zimbabwe were discovered here.

23 Kalakamati Rock Paintings



Three panels of rock paintings are located behind Kalakamati Kgotla. The paintings depict a variety of scenes ranging from dance, hunting, finger prints and various animals which were left behind by the ancestors of Basarwa.

24 Mantenge Wells and Paintings



Mantenge Well is an extraordinary 7 m deep hole on a granite boulder. It is located 4 km east of Kalakamati – Masunga junction. A few rock paintings and extensive remains of 19th century refuge settlement are also found here.

25 Ntimbale Landscape



Ntimbale dam was built on a gorge known as Die Poort. This served as a historic landmark on the old wagon road to Victoria Falls. Several rock painting sites are found here.

NSWAZWI TRAIL

26 Schermer's Ruins



Schermer's Ruins is located 2 km south east of Sebina crossroads. It resembles stone walling style found at Great Zimbabwe. It served as the residence of a chief during the 15th century.

27 BB1 Kgotla



The BB1 kgotla was established in 1940 as the administration capital of the Bangwato in the Bukalanga area. It is located 1 km from the Masunga junction on the east of Tutume road.

28 Nswazwi Royal Cemetery



This cemetery is located at Nswazwi Kgotla. It is the final resting home of She John Madawo Nswazwi who was initially buried in Jetjeni at Rhodesia in 1960.

His remains were repatriated and buried here in June 2002. This grave marks the end of the struggle of Bakalanga ba ka Nswazwi and Bangwato which began in the 1940s.

29 Old Nswazwi Church



The church was built in 1921 by Chiliwa Mbaakanye. It served as a school and community church for the London Missionary Society under Reverend Moses Holonga.

This church is located 4 km northeast of Nswazwi village along the nswazwi Kalamati Road.

30 Nswazwi Potters



Nswazwi Potters make exquisitely decorated pots which are mostly small jars and bowls. The decoration motif consists of contrasting patterns in red ochre and graphite.

31 Magapatona Ruins



This is one of the few terraced stone wall sites found in the region. The ruin was the residence of a district chief during the 17th century.

It is located 7 km northeast of Goshwe at Madandume lands.

Accommodation in DATI TRAIL

H6 **Modumela Lodge**
Cell (+267) 713 027 91 / 721 114 07

Accommodation in DOMBOSHABA TRAIL

H7 **Domboshaba Lodge**
Tel (+267) 248 1071

Accommodation in NSWAZWI TRAIL

H8 **Shumba Lodge**
Tel (+27) 7617 79884 / (+267) 724 917 31

H9 **Mophane Guest House**
Tel (+267) 298 7062 / 717 859 19

FRANCISTOWN CITY TRAIL

This trail celebrates the history of the development of gold mining which began during prehistoric times. Henry Hartley's rediscovery of gold in the lower Tati River in 1867, triggered the first gold rush in Southern Africa.

This resulted in the establishment of a white settlement and several gold mines. The Tati Concession was established in 1800s and acquired rights over much of the land that was previously owned by the Bakalanga.

The trail covers historic buildings, dams, craft centres, parks and historic cemeteries.

1 Shashe Dam



Photo retrieved from: zimbabweflora.co.zw

This dam was opened in 1971. It is the largest man - made water body in the north - eastern part of Botswana.

It is located about 5 km from the A1 road turn off at Shashe Siding. The dam offers popular sporting activities such as surfing, sailing and fishing.

2 Shashe Money Tree



This popular open craft centre is found on the east of the Shashe Siding junction.

Some women sell locally made crafts such as sugar bowls, mophane walking sticks, palm tree hats and candle sticks.

3 Tachila Nature Reserve



This reserve is located 5 km south of Francistown on Lady Mary Ranch.

It covers 8,000 hectares of land which promotes conservation of some endangered and rare species of game.

Zebras, snakes, kudus, birds, eland and small antelopes are found in this reserve.

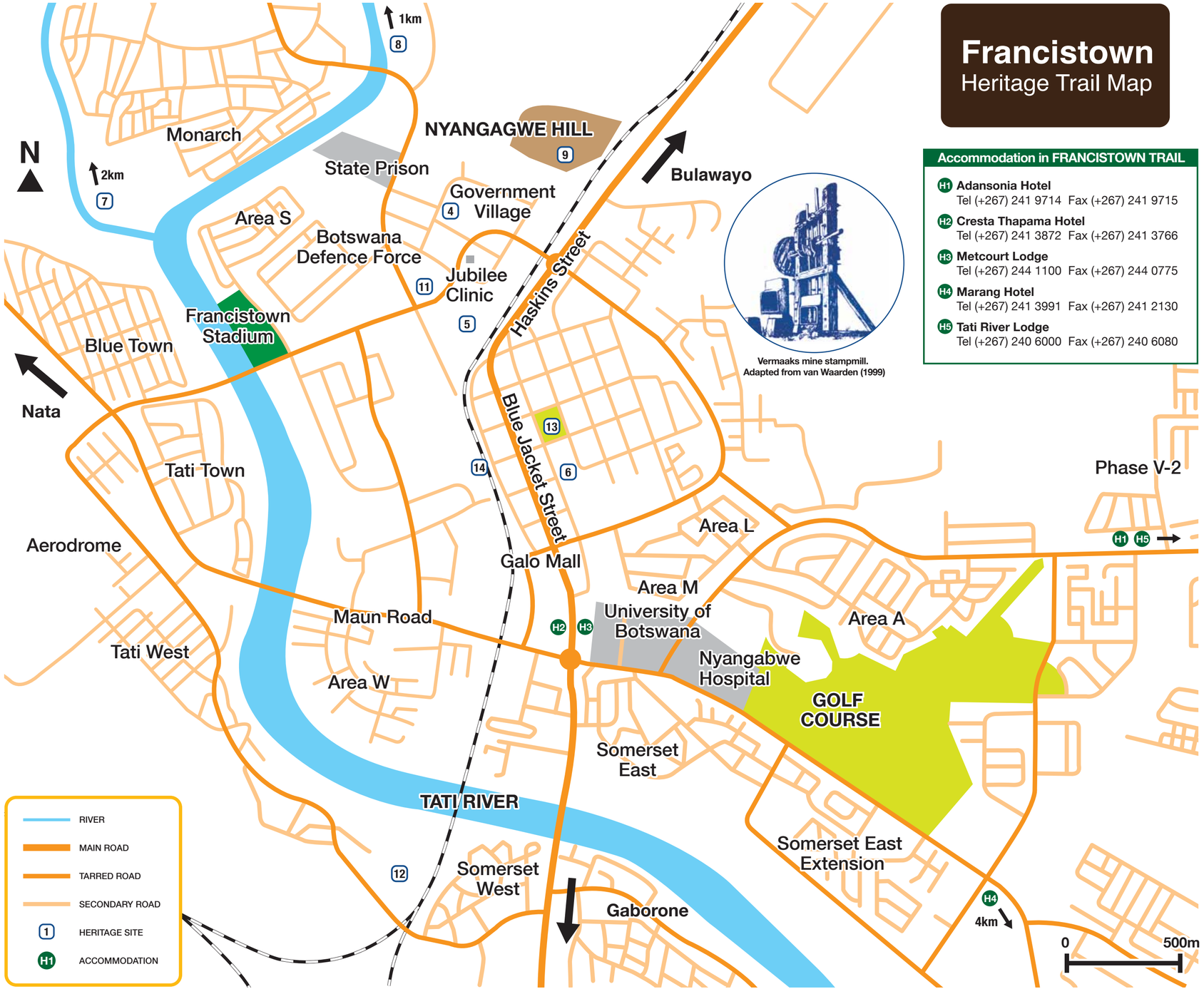
4 Supa Ngwao Museum



This museum is housed in a historic building in the Government Camp near Nyangabwe Hill. It was opened in 1992.

The museum collects and houses temporary exhibitions on the history and ethnography of Bakalanga.

The museum is open on Monday - Saturday from 0900 – 1700 HRS.



Francistown
Heritage Trail Map

Vermaaks mine stampmill.
Adapted from van Waarden (1999)

Accommodation in FRANCISTOWN TRAIL

- H1 **Adansonia Hotel**
  Tel (+267) 241 9714 Fax (+267) 241 9715
- H2 **Cresta Thapama Hotel**
  Tel (+267) 241 3872 Fax (+267) 241 3766
- H3 **Metcourt Lodge**
  Tel (+267) 244 1100 Fax (+267) 244 0775
- H4 **Marang Hotel**
  Tel (+267) 241 3991 Fax (+267) 241 2130
- H5 **Tati River Lodge**
  Tel (+267) 240 6000 Fax (+267) 240 6080

5 Hexagonal Building



This Old Building is located 200 metres south of BHC offices between Supa Ngwao Museum and the railway.

It was built as a guest house for Dr Morgan's residence in historic times.

It has served different purposes such as a dispensary and game room.

6 St Patrick's Church



This church is located on St Patrick Street near John Mackenzie School. It was originally built in 1899.

It burnt down and destroyed its unique broken angle zinc roof.

The current church was built in 1932 imitating the original one. The church bell found here was erected in 1909.

7 Monarch Mine



This old gold mine is located in Monarch. The mine was discovered in 1889 by De Maffy.

It changed ownership to the Blue Jacket Syndicate in 1895 and later on to the Victory Monarch Company.

By 1897, it was the biggest mining operation in the Tati Concession. It crushed over 10 000 tonnes of ore and produced 4000 ounces of gold.

8 Ntshe Dolley Holes

These dolley holes are located 1.5 km north of Monarch Bridge on a granite boulder in Ntshe River.

There are about 15 dolley holes found here. These were used in prehistoric times for crushing and panning of gold.





9 Nyangabwe Hill



This is the tallest hill found in Francistown. It offers a panoramic view of Francistown City.

Nyangabwe Hill is the best starting point of the Francistown city heritage trail.

There is an extensive Leopards Kopje terrace wall and a historic refuge stone wall.

10 Gerald Estate Monument



This geological monument is located near BHC houses in Gerald Estate.

It was discovered in 2010 during construction of BHC houses. These geological formations are very rare in Southern Africa as volcanic activities are very rare.

The columnar blocks found here resulted from quick cooling of lava flow during volcanic activities some million years ago.

Spectacular blocks of stones found here have hexagonal shapes. This outlook gives them an eerie appearance that suggests that they were humanly shaped.

11 Historic Cemetery

This cemetery is the resting place of members of prominent Francistown families such as the Haskins, Grenfell and Rouncifell. There are over 50 graves found in this cemetery. The oldest burials date back to 1896.

It is located in a stone wall south west of Supa Ngwao Museum.



12 Riverside Extension Cemetery





This cemetery is located in Matjimenjenga near Tati River.

76 mine workers from Angola, Nyasaland and Rhodesia buried here died in WNLA DC4 Skymaster plane crash in 1974. Phillip Matante, one of the founding fathers of the Bechuanaland People's Party is also buried here.

13 Sam Edward's Square



This recreation park is named after a 19th century game hunter and trader named Sam Edwards.

He grew up among Batswana and was given the Tati Concession by King Lobengula for the Northern Light Gold Exploration Company. The Moth Monument at this site was built by WNLA in memory of soldiers who died during World War II.

14 Railway Station



The railway station has old cottages of a fascinating Victorian style.

The railway station offices served as a post office in the past. An old steam locomotive on display here was donated by Rhodesia Railway.

Photo courtesy of Geoff Cooke

It is a Beyer Garrett, 15th Class which regularly passed through Francistown before 1975.